THE KEEPER OF LOST THINGS

By Ruth Hogan

CHAPTER I: Padua

Anthony Peardew was the keeper of lost things.
For forty years he had rescued lost items from trains, cafes, and parks:
a jigsaw piece, a single blue glove, a brass door key, a bone hairclip.
Each was carefully cataloged with the date and place where it was found,
waiting for the day they might be reunited with their rightful owners.

CHAPTER II: The Inheritance

Laura sat in the sunny drawing room of Padua, her heart overflowing.
Anthony had left her the grand Victorian house, the lush garden,
and the sacred mission to find homes for the four thousand lost items.
Beside her, Freddy the gardener smiled softly through the French doors.